

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Harappan chronology: regional roots to localisation

EARLY/REGIONALISATION -> MATURE/INTEGRATION -> LATE/LOCALISATION

c. 3300-2600 BCE	c. 2600-1900 BCE	c. 1900-1300 BCE
regional towns/crafts and exchange networks	shared weights, seals, script, urban systems	de-urbanisation, local ceramics, settlement shifts, continuities
+-----+-----+		
v		

Civilisation = integrated urban-rural network; decline = regional transformation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Harappan spatial system and site atlas

WEST: Sutkagendor -> Makran edge | NORTH: Manda -> Jammu frontier

CORE INDUS: Harappa -> urban/cemetery sequence | Mohenjo-daro -> Great Bath/drains

GHAGGAR: Kalibangan -> ploughed field/fire installations | Banawali -> fortified town

EAST: Rakhigarhi -> major Haryana complex | Alamgirpur -> eastern Late Harappan edge

KUTCH: Dholavira -> three-part city, reservoirs, signboard | Surkotada -> fortification

GUJARAT: Lothal -> basin/warehouse/craft debate | Rangpur -> regional sequence

SINDH: Chanhudaro -> craft centre; no classic citadel-lower-town profile

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Urban-rural settlement hierarchy

FARM/PASTORAL HAMLETS -> VILLAGES -> CRAFT/ROUTE CENTRES -> REGIONAL CITIES

food and herds storage specialised output coordination/consumption

| | | |
+-----+-----+-----+-----+

v

weights + seals + transport + shared styles connect unequal regional domains.

Urbanism depended on rural surplus and raw-material corridors; cities were not isolated.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Built order, water and civic maintenance

PLANNED STREETS + STANDARD BRICKS + PLATFORMS + COURTYARD HOUSES

|

v

wells/reservoirs -> bathing areas -> covered drains -> soak pits/inspection access

|

+-----+-----+

|

household investment

|

collective maintenance

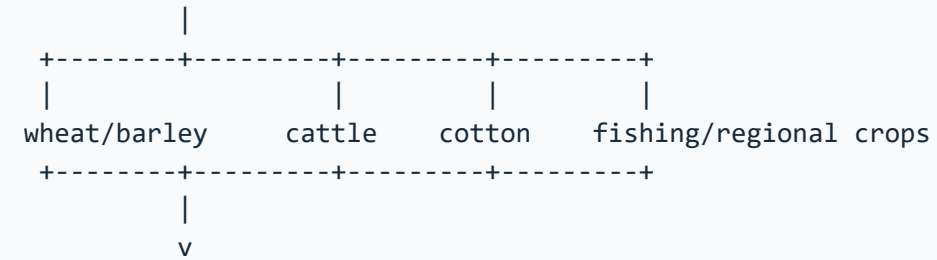
+-----+-----+

v

Dholavira adapts reservoirs to aridity; Mohenjo-daro stresses wells and drains.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: The Harappan economy as a linked system

AGRICULTURAL-PASTORAL BASE



SURPLUS -> craft workshops -> calibrated weights -> seals/transport -> exchange

CRAFTS: beads, shell, faience, pottery, copper/bronze; stone remains important.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Internal and overseas exchange corridors

RAW MATERIAL FLOW

Baluchistan/Afghanistan -> metals/stones -> Indus cities

Rajasthan/Khetri -> copper corridor -> production zones

Gujarat/Kutch -> shell, carnelian, coastal routes -> crafts and ports

Indus/Makran/Gulf -> Dilmun/Magan -> Mesopotamia; Meluhha in cuneiform texts

|

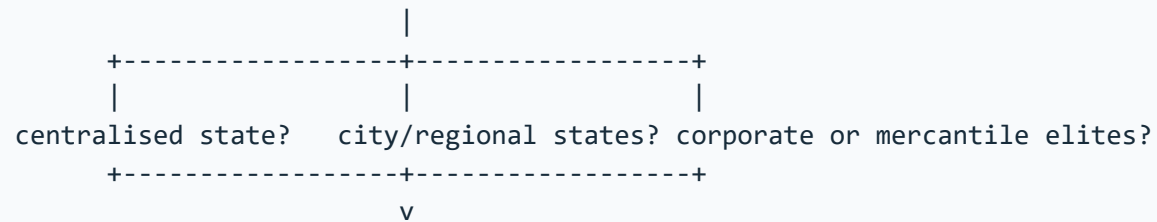
v

Trade evidence = imports + texts + seals + production; it does not prove colonies.

Lothal basin has dockyard/reservoir interpretations: state the debate.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Society and polity: evidence without invented kings

EVIDENCE: house variation + scarce goods + craft control + standards + public works



NO secure palace, royal tomb or deciphered king-list; hierarchy existed, form is open.
VERDICT: coordinated institutions are certain; empire-level sovereignty is unproven.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Script, seals and religion: evidence ladder

SECURE: short signs, seals/tablets, motifs, ritual installations, burials, figurines

PROBABLE: identity/transaction marking and differentiated ritual practices

DISPUTED: script language; proto-Shiva; mother-goddess system; universal fire altars

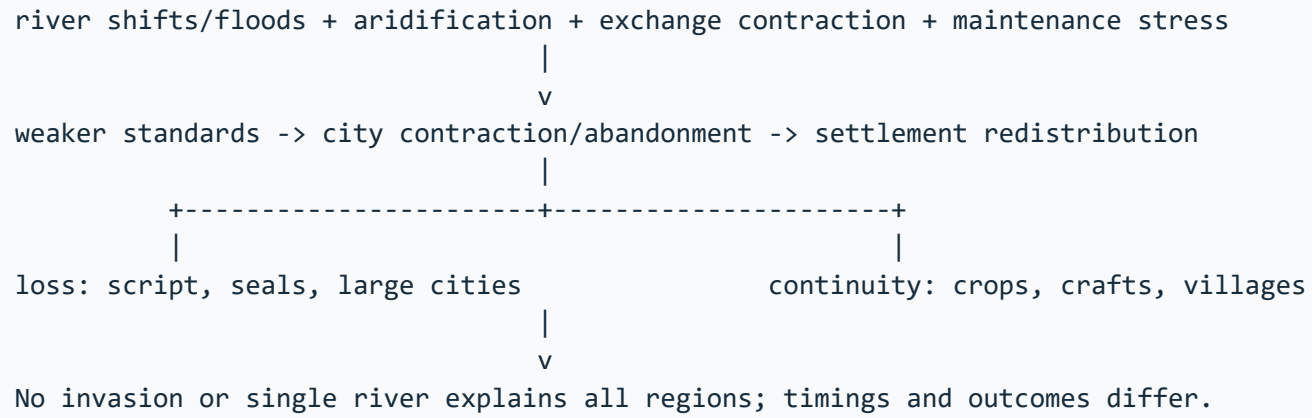
REJECT: reading later Hindu doctrine directly into every Harappan image.

|
v

Undeciphered script blocks direct access to office, belief and political vocabulary.

Use object + context + distribution before analogy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: De-urbanisation: interacting regional causes



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Harappan answer architecture: 10/15/20 marks

10 MARKS: phase -> site-feature triad -> mechanism -> interpretation caution

15 MARKS: chronology -> spatial system -> urban form -> economy -> polity/religion limits

20 MARKS: integration -> site map -> urban-rural economy -> water/standards/trade

-> society-polity evidence -> script/ritual limits -> transformation

BENCHMARK: material uniformity indicates integration, not automatic political unity.

CLOSE: a varied civilisation coordinated by standards, exchange and maintenance.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. Site Location / river Signature find
3. Spindle whorls are common craft evidence; shell/ivory scales and...

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Evidence discipline: contested chronology and interpretation remain...
2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.